25900373

MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM MGU-UGP (HONOURS)

Regular Examination October 2025

Third Semester

Discipline Specific Elective (DSE)

MG3DSEENG200 - **INTRODUCTION TO FILM STUDIES**

Duration: 2 Hours Maximum Marks: 70

Scheme of Valuation

Part A

MCQ

Answer all questions. Each question carries 1 mark

1.	d. Heard by characters	(CO1,2,3,4)
2.	c. Twists, turns and retardations in the plot.	(CO2)
3.	a. Use of non-professional child actors and realistic settings.	(CO3)
4.	c. The idealised mother figure	(CO4)
5.	a. Film Noir	(CO3)
6.	a. Cahiers du Cinema	(CO4)
7.	d. Documentary	(CO2)
8.	b. Expressionist architecture and futuristic set design	(CO3)
9.	b. Pensive spectator	(CO4)
10.	c. Vertov	(CO3)

(1 x 10 = 10)

Part B

SHORT ANSWER

Answer any 6 questions. Each question carries 5 marks

11. “Notes on Auteur theory”- Andrew Sarris - director- primary creative force behind a film - Director as auteur (author) of a film - defends auteur theory in three premises - technical competence (master the craft) - distinguishable personality (signature stylistic traits which recurs in works) - interior meaning (the meaning/work generated from the tension between the director’s personality and the material)

(CO4)

12. Rodolfo and Dora's engagement celebration-at the Grand Hotel - appalled by the Pro-Nazi sentiment of the party, Dora asks Guido to take her away - Guido rode on Eliseo's horse, "Robin Hood" (painted green and had "Jewish horse" graffitied on its side) called for Dora who willingly leapt onto the horse to leave with Guido, humiliating Rodolfo in front of all the guests.

(CO2)

13. Bicycle Thieves by Vittorio de Sica - Social poverty is reflected in the struggle of Antonio Ricci to get back his bicycle - his only means of livelihood - Institutions as pawn shops - post war economic crisis – Rome, Open City – city itself becomes a text of poverty – endurance - suffers humiliation but continues the search - collectivity and solidarity - Close shots and importance to gestures focuses on mindscapes of character.

(CO3)

14. Iconography arises from the repetition of visual and narrative codes over a series of films, establishing a shorthand that audiences understand instantly. Eg. the white hat represents heroism, the black hat evil, and the saloon a realm of moral compromise - a genre's iconography also indicates thematic values - this coding runs deeper than simply aesthetics to include dialogue, music, and even casting.

(CO2)

15. Pather Panchali - authentic depiction of the daily lives of the poor people in rural Bengal - subtle emotions and real life struggles of human beings - influence of Italian neorealism is evident in the rejection of the styles and values of commercial cinema, use of natural locations, amateur and non-professional artists, lack of makeup, exaggerated gestures, open ended story.

(CO3)

16. In Modern Times (1936), Charlie Chaplin portrays the Great Depression through satire and symbolism that expose industrial dehumanization and social struggle - opening scene - compares factory workers to sheep, showing how labourers were herded and controlled by the system - the Tramp's breakdown on the assembly line and his being swallowed by the machine - Chaplin illustrates how industrial labour consumes both body and mind - Scenes of stealing to survive, repeated unemployment, and being mistaken for a communist reflect the desperation and political anxiety of the era - film ends with Charlie and the girl walking toward an uncertain future - symbolizing hope, resilience, and human companionship - amid economic despair.

(CO 1,2,3,4)

17. Feminine Mystique, despite the social and cultural advancements social conditioning is that "women are destined to be mothers and wives"- Double enslavement, pressure to outshine in domestic spaces and professional areas - Malayalam film portrays this paradoxical state of women caught between the two.

(CO4)

18. In Breathless (1960), Jean-Luc Godard portrays Michel Poiccard and Patricia Franchini as physically close but emotionally distant, reflecting modern alienation - Michel imitates American gangster films, while Patricia's emotional indecision and fragmented conversations reveal disconnection and confusion - Dialogue often lacks coherence, mirroring disillusioned mindset of the postwar generation - Michel's amorality and criminal acts blur the line between freedom and rebellion, while Patricia's foreignness in Paris represents a rootless sense of liberty - their relationship becomes a temporary space of liberation, exposing the instability and uncertainty of love and freedom in an existential world. (CO3)

19. Auteur Theory - coined by Andrew Sarris argues that the director is the primary creative force behind a film, shaping it through personal style and thematic consistency - Auteur shows technical competence, personal coherence, and a distinctive worldview across their works - idea originated from the French New Wave of the 1950s and 1960s, which rebelled against traditional storytelling and studio dominance - Critics from Cahiers du Cinéma promoted the Politique des auteurs, emphasizing the director's unique artistic vision over commercial production - Director became viewed as the author of the film, expressing individuality and creativity through cinematic form and narrative. (CO3)

(6 x 5 = 30)

Part C

ESSAY

Answer any 2 questions. Each question carries 15 marks

20. Laura Mulvey's "Visual Pleasure and Narrative Cinema"- Critical study and exposing of the innate nature of reinforcing patriarchal structures through narrative designs in Hollywood cinema by psychoanalytical study methods- ubiquitous "male gaze", "voyeuristic pleasure" of audience- women as passive objects subjected to the agency of patriarchal power- Feminist film making- avant garde films- counter film narration by critical awareness among audience and materiality of camera- redesign film making by equal distribution of agency of power and perspective.

(CO4)

21. French poetic realism - Film movement in France- Lyrical narration blended with realism- Stylization, romance, melancholy- Use of symbolism- emotional ambience important than plot- working class worries narrated in a poetic tone- usually the protagonists are unsuccessful people like criminals or dreamers- Climax most probably tragic- reflects disillusionment in France.

(CO1,2,3,4)

22. Traditional film genres - straightforward storytelling - reflected dominant social ideologies – met audience expectations - shift to self-conscious formalism - films more aware of their own form and conventions - changing audience pleasure from passive enjoyment to recognizing genre manipulation - John Ford's The Searchers (1956) subverts the heroic Western - Ethan Edwards as a racist, obsessive anti-hero - film's moral ambiguity questions the myth of the noble frontier and the clarity of traditional "genres of order"- Vincente Minnelli's The Band Wagon (1953) parodies its own musical-romantic conventions, using self-awareness to satirize the artifice of show business.

(CO2)

23. Italian Neorealism- Post World war film movement in Italy - realistic portrayal of poor and working class – Characteristics: use of non-professional actors - poverty and unemployment as themes - realistic approach to issues - Vittorio de Sica, director of Bicycle Thieves - Two commoners, Lamberto Maggiorani and Enzo Staiola played the main characters- shooting in open spaces (factory, streets of Rome), Non professionals as crowd- tram, stops, buildings- natural camera lighting.

(CO3)

(15 x 2 = 30)